

Roasted potatoes, chickpeas, and spinach with Spicy cashew sauce

This is an exceptionally flavorful, quick meal-in-a-pot. I like to use nut butters other than peanut when I can. Cashew butter is an excellent vehicle for flavor, and it has a silky consistency. Cashew butter is, in fact, very creamy, almost luscious, not unlike dairy butter. Serve with a bowl of plain yogurt, warm bread, and your favorite chutney.

2 pounds small red potatoes, scrubbed and quartered [1kg]

¼ cup peanut oil [60ml]

¼ teaspoon salt

1 tablespoon fennel seeds

1 tablespoon ground cumin

1 teaspoon turmeric

1 cinnamon stick

1 medium onion, coarsely chopped

1 fresh jalapeño pepper, minced

1½ inches of fresh ginger, peeled and minced [4cm]

2 garlic cloves, minced

2 cans (15 ounces each) chickpeas, drained [850g total]

½ cup cashew butter [120g]

2 tablespoons tomato paste

¾ cup vegetable stock or water [200ml]

1 bunch of spinach (about 4 ounces), washed, thick stems discarded, leaves coarsely chopped or left whole if baby leaves [125g]

¼ teaspoon freshly ground pepper

1. **Preheat** the oven to 400°F [200°C]. Toss the quartered potatoes with 1 tablespoon of the peanut oil and ¼ teaspoon of the salt. Spread out on a baking sheet and roast 35 to 45 minutes, or until tender and nicely browned. Turn the potatoes once while they roast for even browning.

2. In a large dry skillet, **toast** the fennel seeds, cumin, turmeric, and cinnamon stick over medium heat, stirring, until fragrant and a shade or two darker, 1 to 2 minutes.
3. Add the remaining oil, the onion, jalapeño pepper, ginger, and garlic to the spices. **Cook**, stirring occasionally, until the onion is very soft and a touch browned, about 5 minutes. Add the chickpeas, cashew butter, tomato paste, and vegetable stock, stirring to blend. Bring to a boil, reduce the heat to a simmer, and cook until the sauce thickens, 5 to 7 minutes.
4. Stir in the roasted potatoes and the spinach. Cook just until the spinach wilts, 1 to 2 minutes. **Season** with the remaining salt and the pepper. Discard the cinnamon stick before serving.

SERVES 6

